

MAKE CHORDS GROOVE

The Rhythm Piano Playbook



Introduction *from Adam*

This lesson shows you how I take one simple chord progression and make it feel alive in three different grooves. You'll learn how rhythm, touch, and left-hand support can completely change the feel of the same chords.

Groove #1

Uptempo Disco



video 2:13



Download the drum track from the video

This **upbeat disco groove** has lots of forward motion and a bright, driving feel.

Start with steady octaves in the **left hand** and a simple rhythmic pattern **in the right**, locking tightly to the drum groove. Then try adding an **octave line** at the end of the phrase for variation.

Push!

Octave line!



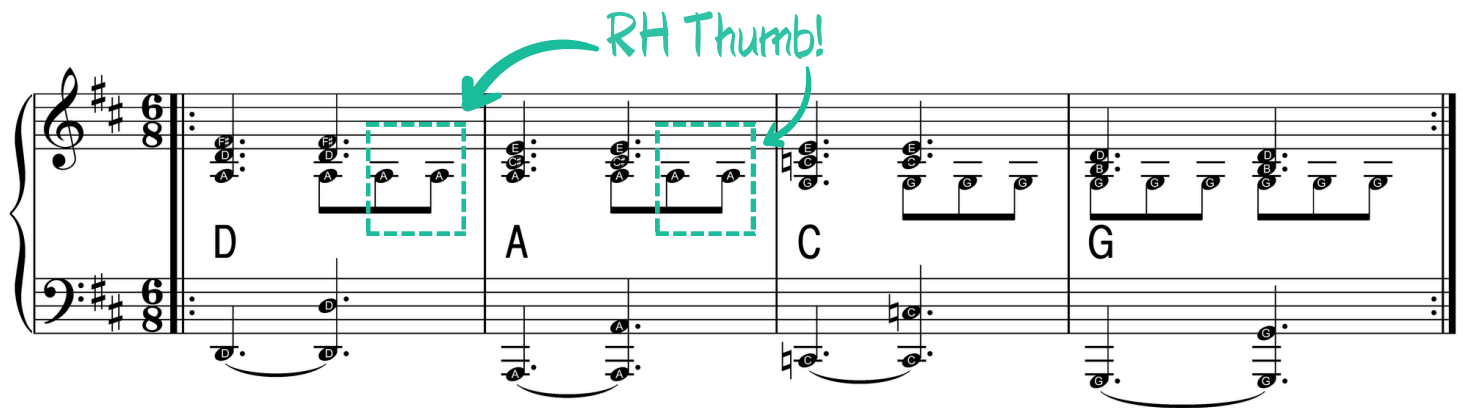
"Listen closely to the drum track, feel how your part relates to the kick and snare, and lock into the pulse!"

Groove #2

6/8 Soul Classic

 video 5:49

This 6/8 groove has a **rolling, soulful feel**, with the subdivision driving everything forward.



Musical notation for Groove #2, 6/8 time. The right hand (RH) plays a melody with a rolling feel, and the left hand (LH) plays a steady bass line. The melody is divided into four measures, each with a chord label: D, A, C, and G. The first two measures are highlighted with a dashed green box, and a green arrow points to the RH Thumb! text above the first measure.

Use the **thumb in your right hand** to generate rhythm in the gaps, and let the left hand hold the chords steady so the groove feels smooth and natural.

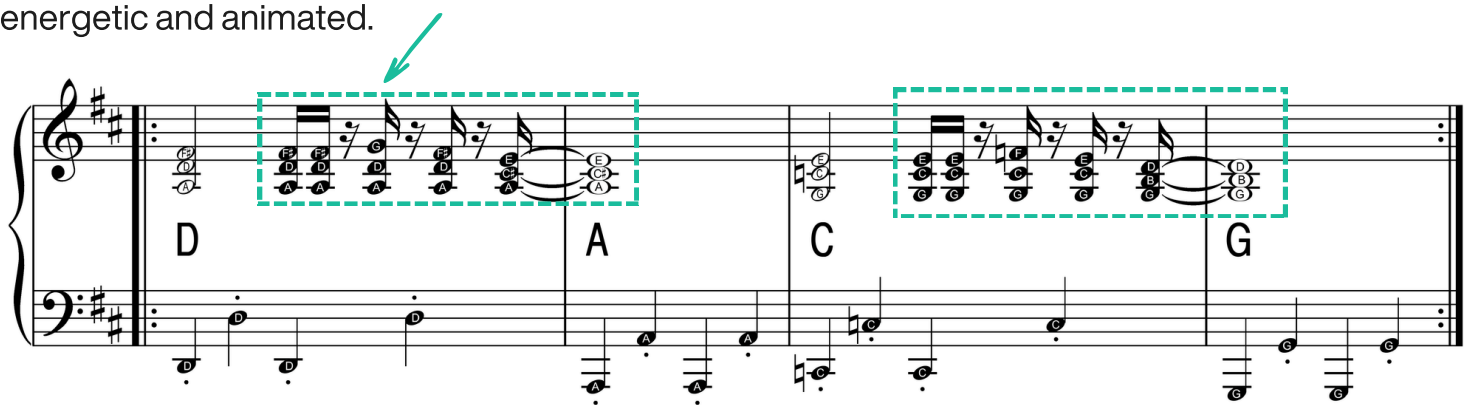
Groove #3

Folk Rock Backbeat

 video 9:27

This folk-rock groove has a **heavier backbeat** and a more urgent, driving feel.

Lay the **left hand** down like a steady bass player, then add a simple **right-hand riff** with a bit of rhythmic bite and **16th-note movement** so the part feels energetic and animated.



Musical notation for Groove #3, 6/8 time. The right hand (RH) plays a steady bass line, and the left hand (LH) plays a melody with a driving feel. The melody is divided into four measures, each with a chord label: D, A, C, and G. The first two measures are highlighted with a dashed green box, and a green arrow points to the RH riff text above the first measure.



Meet Your Coach

Adam Saunders

Adam is the founder of The Keys Coach, helping piano players unlock freedom, confidence, and creativity at the keys.

He is a **Professor at Trinity Laban Conservatoire, London** where he co-founded their Popular Music degree—one of the first of its kind in the UK.

He's a **published author**, international **keynote speaker**, and **professional piano player** who has performed on global stages and major TV networks.

The mission: to help you break free from rigid, traditional methods so you can play with true *musicality, creativity, and joy*.

